

A DATA PROSPECTOR'S REPORT

THE AI GOLD RUSH

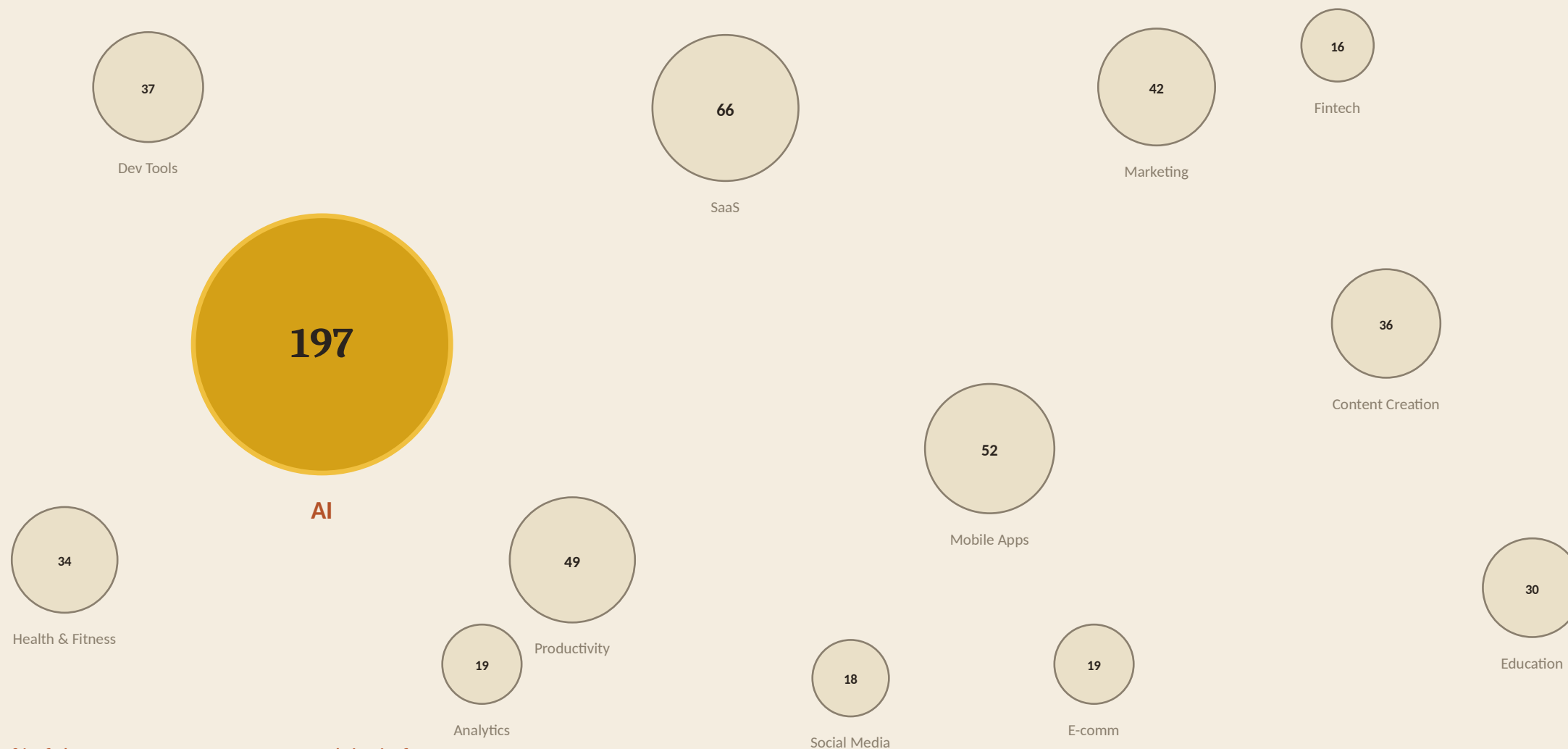
Everyone's staking a claim. Is anyone actually striking it rich?

1,000
CLAIMS
SURVEYED

CLAIM MAP

Everyone's digging in the same spot

Each marker is a category, sized by how many businesses have staked a claim there.

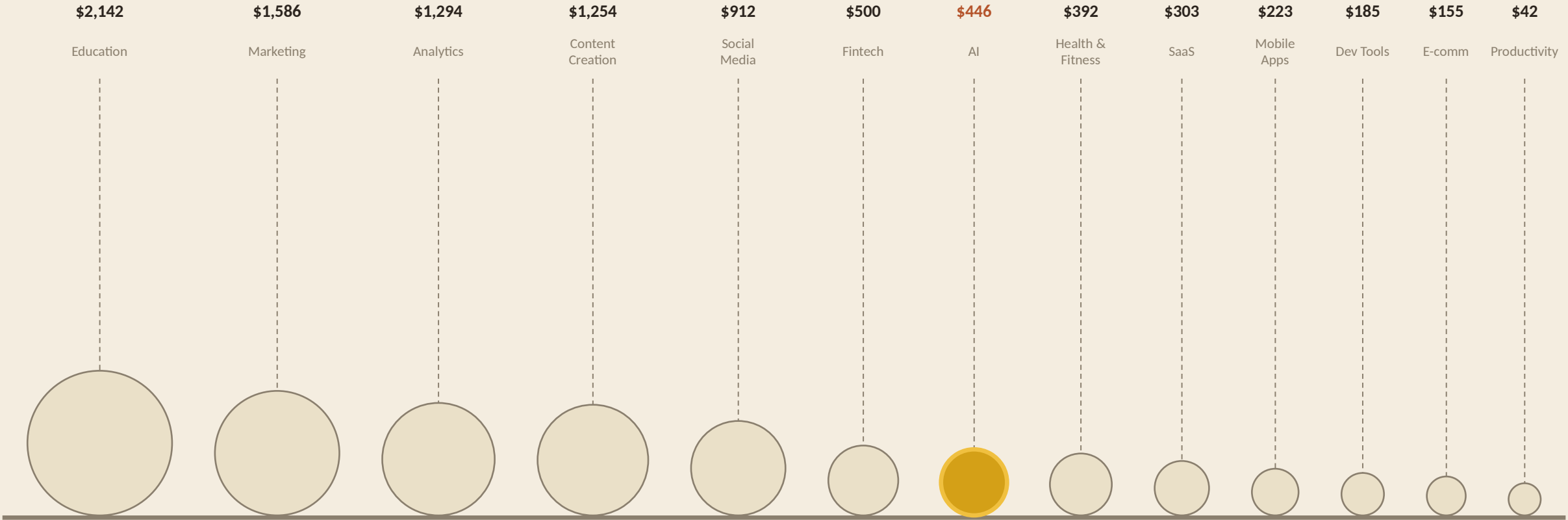


27% of the map — one category, one claim in four

THE YIELD

But AI's claim isn't the richest one

Nuggets sized by median monthly recurring revenue per category. AI sits 7th of 13.



HEAD TO HEAD

The crowded claim vs. the quiet one



AI

197 claims filed

\$446

median MRR

13.7%

earn zero revenue

The rush. Most crowded field on the map — highest founder density, mid-pack payout.



Education

30 claims filed

\$2,142

median MRR

10.0%

earn zero revenue

The quiet claim. 6.6x fewer diggers, nearly 5x the median revenue per business.

Where AI actually ranks

13 categories, ranked by median monthly recurring revenue

1	Education	\$2,142
2	Marketing	\$1,586
3	Analytics	\$1,294
4	Content Creation	\$1,254
5	Social Media	\$912
6	Fintech	\$500
7	AI	\$446
8	Health & Fitness	\$392
9	SaaS	\$303
10	Mobile Apps	\$223
11	Dev Tools	\$185
12	E-comm	\$155
13	Productivity	\$42

7

of 13

AI's rank by revenue — despite being 3x more crowded than any other field.

STILL DIGGING

Middling revenue, middling momentum

13.7%

of AI listings report zero
30-day revenue

35.5%

of AI listings show any positive
revenue growth at all

30-day revenue growth: share of businesses
showing ANY gain

AI



Rest of market



*Essentially a coin flip either way — the AI label
buys no growth edge.*

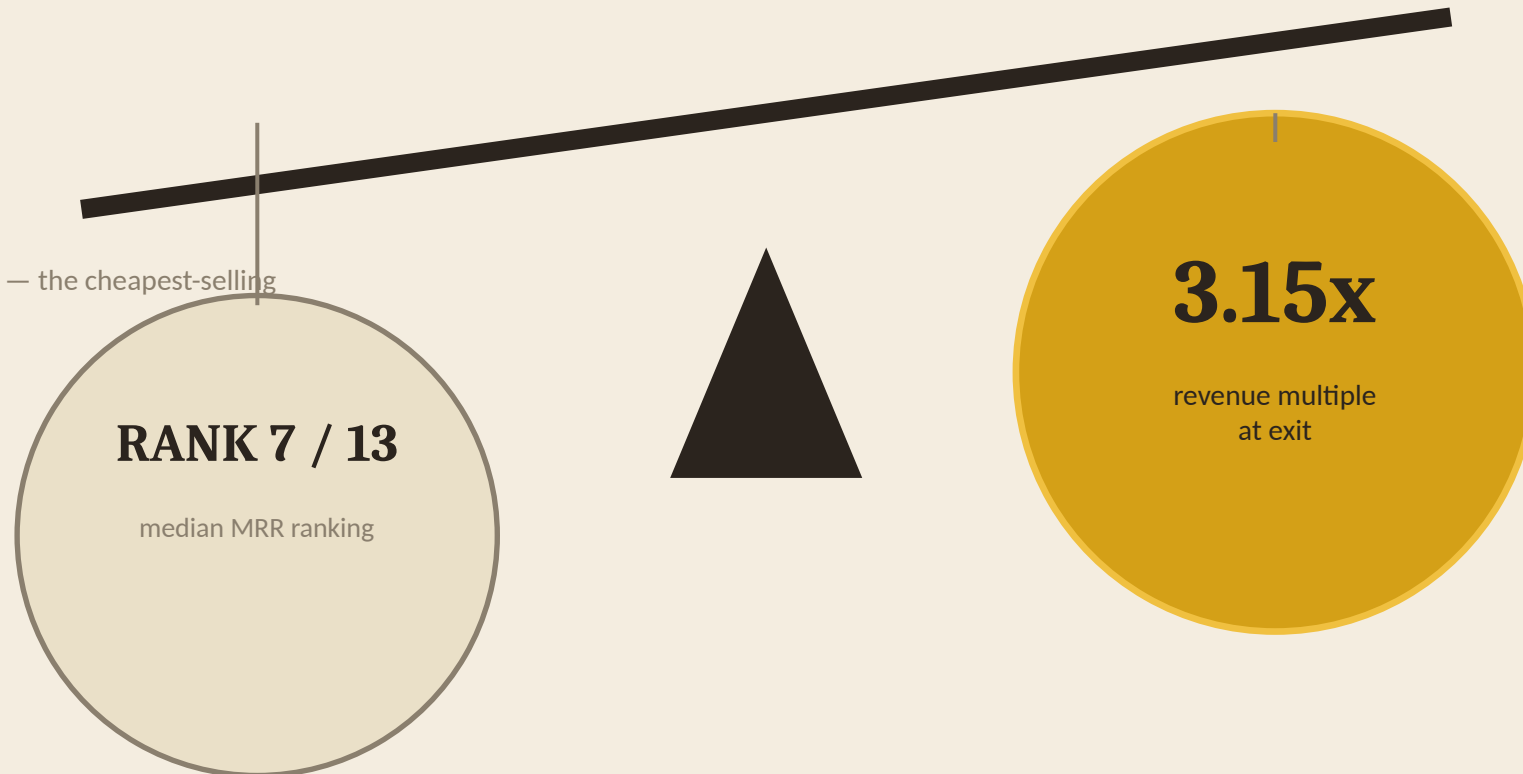
Buyers pay for the name, not just the numbers

2.3x

market median exit multiple, all categories

2.6x

AI's multiple vs. SaaS's — 1.2x — the cheapest-selling category



THE VERDICT

A hype premium, not a gold standard.

AI drew 3x more prospectors than any other field, pays out squarely in the middle of the pack, and shows no growth edge over the rest of the market — yet its claims still sell for well above the going rate. The premium is in the label, not the ledger.

3.15x
price

7/13
rank

What this means for you

FOUNDERS

Crowding isn't opportunity

Before staking a claim in AI, price in the competition. Quieter categories may pay more per business.

BUYERS

Check the ledger, not the label

An AI listing at 3.15x isn't automatically worth more than a SaaS listing at 1.2x — compare actual revenue and growth first.

ANALYSTS

Growth, not category, moves price

Recent MRR growth is what correlates with valuation. Category hype is a weaker signal than it looks.